BIMAL PATEL

THE POWER ARCHITECT

The Ahmedabad-based architect has been associated with several high-profile projects closely tied to Prime Minister Narendra Modi—most recently the Kashi Vishwanath Temple Corridor and the controversial Central Vista redevelopment. In the face of mounting criticism against the Central Vista makeover, Patel has also turned spokesman for the project

By Kai Friese

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH



While the past two years have certainly been...memorable, they have not, by and large, been commemorated by any historically significant construction activity—with the exception of a clutch of projects close to the prime minister's heart. The Ram Mandir at Ayodhya, of course. The Kashi Vishwanath temple corridor, recently inaugurated to considerable televised fanfare. And the Central Vista redevelopment—a vast construction site in the heart of the capital that controversially burst into activity while the city was in lockdown and the nearby Parliament in suspension. While Prime Minister Narendra Modi has missed no photo-op to underline his role in bulldozing these projects onto